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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)
REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026
Fifth Semester
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG5DSCENG300 – AMERICAN LITERATURE

Duration: 2 hours Maximum Marks : 70

Scheme for Valuation

PART A – MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. (d) The approval of others [K/CO1]
2. (c) 1920s [K/CO1]
3. (b) cut off his ear [K/CO1]
4. (c) Human arrogance despite real insignificance [U/CO2]
5. (b) Nature continues unchanged despite the human event [U/CO2]
6. (b) Because the neighbours cooperate physically while the wall keeps them emotionally apart [U/CO2]
7. (b) Direct characterization that explain his motivation [E/CO3]
8. Evidently based on Poe's story 'Tell-tale heart', then the answer is "b. It links bodily sound with concealed guilt and psychological exposure." *(Since the question is not accurate marks can be given to students who attempted the question)* [E/CO3]
9. (a) To provide the historical context and personal background necessary to understand Farquhar's crime and motive. [E/CO3]
10. (a) Prostitution [An/CO4]

[1x10 = 10]

Part B – Short Answer
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks.

11. Emerson considers art a form of self-expression because he views it as the outward manifestation of the artist's inner spirit - by creating art, individuals project their unique soul which is connected to universal truth and the divine "Over-Soul" into the physical world. [An/CO1]

12. Emerson argues that an artist can never fully liberate himself from his age and country because every individual is inevitably shaped by the historical, cultural and spiritual environment into which they are born – Even the act of trying to avoid or resist a convention betrays the influence of that very tradition. [An/CO1]

13. This comparison suggests that plants, trees, and animals possess their own beauty, meaning, and stories, just like written poetry. It urges us to view nature not as an inanimate resource, but as a living, communicative art form worthy of deep respect. [An/CO2]

14. Earlier images (like a drying raisin or rotting meat) convey passive neglect, fading, and slow decay. In contrast, "sags like a heavy load" shifts the tone to one of active, physical burden, highlighting the crushing psychological and emotional weight of systemic oppression. [A/CO2]

15. The phrase highlights the mirror's isolated, static, and passive existence. It stares at the opposite wall so continuously that the wall feels like an internal part of the mirror's own "heart,"

emphasizing the repetitive emptiness of its reality, which is only briefly interrupted by darkness or faces. [U/CO2]

16. The narrative effectively proves this by contrasting the hunger required for creation with the complacency of luxury. It demonstrates that wealth often distracts individuals with superficial pleasures and social conformity, draining the raw emotional struggle, focus, and drive necessary for genuine artistic breakthrough. *(Since the question is ambiguous marks may be awarded to sensible attempts)* [E/CO3]

17. Walker shows that Dee's formal, institutional education actually creates a "blindness," alienating her from her roots and causing her to view her heritage as shallow, aesthetic museum pieces. Conversely, the formally "uneducated" Mama and Maggie possess true cultural intelligence because they actively live, understand, and preserve their family's living heritage. [E/CO3]

18. Larry's apple tree represents the Keller family's deeply rooted denial, specifically Kate's refusal to accept her son's death. When the tree is violently snapped by the wind, it foreshadows the shattering of the family's illusions and the devastating arrival of the buried truth about Joe Keller's crimes. [U/CO4]

19. Ann is the moral catalyst and the voice of reality in *All My Sons*. She is independent, grounded, and decisive. Unlike the Kellers, she refuses to be paralyzed by the past or live in denial; her ultimate choice to reveal Larry's letter demonstrates her commitment to truth and accountability over comforting illusions. [An/CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C - Essay

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks.

20. In "A Slave among Slaves," Booker T. Washington portrays the relationship between Black and white people as complex and mutually degraded by the institution of slavery. He highlights the paradoxical loyalty of enslaved people who protected white families during the Civil War and notes a profound lack of vengefulness post-emancipation. Ultimately, Washington observes an irony in their dynamic: slavery left the enslavers helpless and overly dependent, while equipping the formerly enslaved with the practical skills and work ethic necessary to survive and progress independently. [An/CO1]

21. In "O Captain! My Captain!", the flags, bugles, and flowers represent the jubilant celebration of the victorious crowds on the shore. By desperately urging the Captain to "rise up" and witness these honors meant for him, the speaker focuses entirely on the festive external reality to psychologically deny the grim, immediate reality of the Captain's dead body on the deck. [A/CO2]

22. In Hemingway's "The Snows of Kilimanjaro," Harry is dying of a severe gangrene infection in his leg. He explains that it resulted from a seemingly trivial incident two weeks prior: he scratched his knee on a thorn and neglected to apply iodine. The minor untreated scratch became infected, leading to the painless but fatal rotting of his flesh. [E/CO3]

23. Women in the play operate primarily within domestic spheres but act as the emotional and moral anchors of the narrative. Kate Keller represents fierce, misguided maternal devotion, using willful denial to hold her fractured family together. Ann Deever acts as the catalyst for truth and moral accountability, refusing to let the past remain buried. Sue Bayliss provides a cynical, pragmatic counterpoint, exposing the hypocrisy of the idealistic men around her. [An/CO4]

[15x2 = 30]